Commercial Intelligence AI Assistant

Leadership Team Presentation · March 2026

Presented by Ajay Dhankar, sales representative, a European commercial team

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Our competitive edge, cross-cultural intelligence, lives in people's heads.

CRM fields can't capture it. Onboarding docs can't replicate it. Training can't teach it.

We have 7 disconnected systems. We can not connect the dots across all of them.

Current cost: €180,000 a year for 7 senior reps alone (a floor). About €510,000 for the full team of about 20.

2 new EU market launch in Q3. New reps will start with zero institutional memory.

WHAT WE'RE PROPOSING

An AI system that captures what sales reps know, not only what's in the CRM.
Every rep gets the context and cultural intelligence our best people have.

PART 1: THE PROBLEM

The best knowledge doesn't live in our systems

Take a senior sales rep: 5+ years of sales experience with European clients

He knows how to open a first meeting with a european client. Which objections actually mean interest. When a logistics director wants to talk operations before pricing. What phrases don't translate well between EU and Asian HQ. Which cultural cues tell you a client is drifting.

Today? All of that lives in his head. When he leaves, it leaves.

0%	90-120 min	37%	6-9 months
Knowledge retained when senior reps leave	Prep time per call (should be 15-20 min)	Follow-up completion rate (should be 60%+)	Time for new reps to be fully productive

We generate intelligence every day. We don't connect it.

Source	What it holds	The problem
CRM	Deal stage, basic contact info	Structured but incomplete
Call transcripts	What was actually said	Unstructured, not searchable
Email threads	Context, objections, commitments	Buried in inboxes
Debrief notes	What reps learned	Inconsistent, if done at all
Proposals	What we offered, what worked	PDFs nobody searches
LinkedIn activity	Client changes, job moves	Manual monitoring only
Support logs	Product issues, frustrations	Separate system entirely

Five reasons we can't wait

Scalability blocked	Can't scale commercial ops without capturing what works. Hiring more reps reproduces the same problem.
Talent risk is real	Senior reps are burning out as human reference desks. Attrition means permanent knowledge loss.
New market expansion Q3	New-market reps need to be productive from day one. Right now they'd have no institutional foundation.
HQ can't see the pipeline	Leadership decides on 40-60% visibility. Field reporting is fragmented and delayed.
Competitors are building this	European logistics peers are adopting AI-enabled sales. This won't stay a differentiator; it will be table stakes.

Every month we wait: intelligence is generated but not captured, and never recovered

This aligns with three strategic priorities

Operational excellence

Cuts prep time from 90-120 min to 15-20 min per call

Equivalent to 2-3 more client calls per week

Headcount needed only when we have more clients

Knowledge management

Makes institutional knowledge a real capability

Today we lose 100% when senior reps leave

Every conversation becomes training data

Geographic expansion

New reps productive in 3-4 months instead of 6-9

New market launch gets immediate access to the France playbook

HQ gets real-time pipeline visibility

It advises reps. It learns from them. They stay in control.

WHAT IT DOES

Gives context-aware suggestions before calls

Improves through rep feedback and periodic retraining

Reps have the final say on everything

Lower risk than automation, higher value than static tools

THREE PROBLEMS THIS SOLVES

New joiners don't know what good looks like. The AI shows real examples from successful interactions.

Senior reps are burning out. The AI handles repetitive queries and cuts informal escalations by 30%.

Good work is invisible. The system shows which actions correlate with wins.

WHY THIS MATTERS

The more we use it, the more accurate and culturally precise it gets. Value compounds over time, and competitors can't replicate it without building their own data corpus over years.

Clear targets at every stage

DAY 90: pilot proof point

- 4 of 5 reps rate it 7/10 or higher
- Prep time down 25% or more (about 80 min)
- CRM quality stays at 75% minimum
- System uptime above 99.5%

MONTH 12-18: scale validation

- Deal cycle under 35 days (now 42)
- Follow-up rate above 60% (now 37%)
- New joiners productive in 3-4 months (now 6-9)
- Senior reps carry 30% less informal load

YEAR 3: institutional asset

- Pipeline visibility above 80% for HQ
- Knowledge retained when people leave (measurable)
- New market reps ramp 30-40% faster than baseline
- Model accuracy improving every quarter

If we don't hit the Day 90 targets: STOP. Maximum loss €109k.

PART 1: ALTERNATIVES WE COMPARED

We compared five options before choosing one

Option	3-year cost	What it gives us	Why we did or didn't choose it
1. Do nothing	€0 upfront; about €180k a year lost	No change, no risk	The cost grows with the team, and new market launches with no institutional memory
2. Better CRM hygiene and manual coordination	About €60k a year (0.5 FTE plus training)	Cleaner records	Linear cost. It does not link calls, email and proposals, and it does not scale
3. Off-the-shelf sales-intelligence platform	€80-120k a year (about €240k and up over 3 years)	Fast to start	Generic insight, not our cultural context. Vendor lock-in, GDPR complexity, no IP of our own
4. Hire more senior reps	€120-180k a year per hire	More capacity	Repeats the single-point-of-failure problem at high fixed cost
5. Custom assistant (our choice)	€364k over 3 years	Captures our own cross-cultural knowledge. Data and IP stay in-house. Staged gates	Costs more than option 3 on paper, so the case rests on knowledge capture and control, not on price

If the Phase 0 gates are not met, we stop and revisit options 2 and 3.

FINANCIAL SUMMARY

The numbers work, even in the worst case

NPV

€626k

12% discount rate

IRR

153%

Strong return

Payback

14 months

Breaks even fast

3-Year ROI

239%

More than 2x return

Total 3-year cost

€364,000

All-in investment

Even if only half the benefit arrives (50% benefit realisation): €313k NPV and 91% IRR

If the full benefit arrives (100%): €939k NPV and 208% IRR

The financial case holds in all three scenarios

FINANCIAL SUMMARY: STRESS TESTS

We tried to break the numbers

All costs +20%

€564k

NPV, base case

Only prep-time savings count

€268k

NPV, 19-month payback

5 prepared calls a week, not 7

€460k

NPV, base case

Break-even

25%

of the modelled benefit (40% if only prep time counts)

The extra deals, the follow-up gain and the onboarding benefit are estimates. Phase 0 and the pilot will test them. The case stays positive without them.

PART 2: COST OF DOING NOTHING

Waiting isn't free

€180,000 a year

Documented waste, senior cohort only (7 reps)
Prep time · missed follow-ups · rework

€510,000 a year

Full commercial team (about 20 reps)
Compounds with every new hire

Complete knowledge loss

Every time a senior rep leaves.
Unquantifiable but strategically real.

New market expansion at risk

Q3 launch with no institutional foundation.

Competitive erosion

European peers are building this.

3-year cost if we don't act: €540k to €1.5M in documented inefficiency

€180k is a floor: 7 senior reps × 85 minutes avoided per call × 5 strategic calls a week × 48 weeks × €75 an hour.

PART 2: INVESTMENT SUMMARY

Phased approach with hard stop points

PHASE 0

Readiness check

4 weeks · €15,000

CRM audit and backfill
Co-design with reps
GDPR sign-off
Security design sign-off

GATE: CRM under 75%, no GDPR memo or no security sign-off means STOP

PHASE 1

Pilot

13 weeks · €94,000

Pilot, 5-7 reps
CRM and call- transcript integration,
150 annotated transcripts
AI Owner moves to 0.3 FTE

Day 45: adjust if needed
Day 90: go or no-go
Max total loss €109k (phase 0-1)

PHASE 2-3

Scale and Run

33 months · €255,000

Full team on the tool
Activate remaining data sources (professional network, support logs)
New-market playbooks
Leadership dashboard live
Annual retraining cycle

Total 3-year cost: €364k
Net benefit: €870k

PART 2: THREE-YEAR FINANCIAL PROJECTION

Base case: 75% of the modelled benefit arrives

YEAR 1 · 5 reps

Prep time savings: €115,500
Faster deal cycles: €60,000

Gross benefit (100%): €175,500

Base case €131.6k · cost €85k · net €46.6k

YEAR 2 · 12 reps

Prep time savings: €360,000
Faster deal cycles: €180,000
Better follow-up: €40,000

Gross benefit (100%): €580,000

Base case €435k · cost €85k · net €350k

YEAR 3 · 18 reps

Prep time savings: €540,000
Faster deal cycles: €270,000
New market onboarding: €80,000

Gross benefit (100%): €890,000

Base case €667.5k · cost €85k · net €582.5k

3-YEAR GROSS BENEFIT: €1,645,500 · Year 0 cost (Phase 0 and 1): €109k

NPV €626k · IRR 153% · Payback 14 months · ROI 239% · Net benefit €870k

Sensitivity (NPV · IRR · payback)

50% arrives: €313k · 91% · 18 months | 75%: €626k · 153% · 14 months | 100%: €939k · 208% · 12 months

PART 3: GOVERNANCE STRUCTURE

Who owns what

Role	Authority	Cadence
Executive sponsor: VP Commercial Ops	Phase gate approvals, budget, strategic direction	Bi-weekly in Phase 1, monthly after
Project owner: Director, Sales Enablement	Day-to-day execution, vendor management, rep engagement	Weekly team meetings
AI Owner (critical new role)	User support, feedback, data quality, escalation	Daily sync. The most important hire
Rep advisory group (5-7 pilot reps)	Co-design, testing, adoption champions	Weekly 30-minute sessions
Legal and compliance	GDPR, data processing, audit protocols	Phase 0 exit, Day 90, Phase 2
Technical partner	Platform, integration, infrastructure, SLA	Sprint reviews, uptime reporting

PART 3: ADOPTION AND DATA QUALITY

Adoption won't happen by accident: we co-design it

ADOPTION TARGETS

Active usage: 75% of pilot reps use it 3 times a week by Day 45

Task coverage: 60% of pre-call preps use it by Day 90

Feedback loop: 40% of outputs rated or corrected by reps

Onboarding: new reps use it productively within 3 days

Escalations: informal questions to seniors down 30% by Month 6

DATA QUALITY CHECKS

Completeness: 8 key CRM fields filled on active deals

Consistency: deal stages match across CRM, email and transcripts

Transcript lag: calls ingested within 24 hours

Model performance: brief relevance rated 1-5 by reps; hallucination incidents counted

Data freshness: escalate if the lag exceeds 48 hours

Weekly AI Owner report · monthly cross-source audit · quarterly deep audit

PART 3: RISK ASSESSMENT

Seven risks, scored before and after

Risk	Impact	Likelihood	Score	Mitigation
CRM data too messy	High	Medium	12 → 6	Phase 0 gate: need 75% before we start
Reps think it's surveillance	High	Medium	12 → 5	Co-design in Phase 0. It helps reps; it does not monitor them
Too much admin burden	Medium	High	12 → 4	5-field debrief, 3 minutes, inside CRM
AI gives wrong advice	High	Medium	12 → 3	A rep reviews every output. The AI labels everything as a suggestion
GDPR violation	Critical	Low	5 → 1	Legal review in Phase 0. Signed compliance memo before any data
Model gets worse over time	Medium	Medium	9 → 3	Annual retraining, AI Owner monitors, quarterly audits
Pilot fails (€109k at risk)	Medium	Low	3 → 2	Day 45 checkpoint lets us adjust before Day 90

Score = impact × likelihood. Impact: Medium 3, High 4, Critical 5. Likelihood: Low 1, Medium 3, High 4. The next two slides give the specific policies.

Ethical risks and the specific policies that answer them

Risk	Policy we will adopt	Owner	Evidence we keep
Bias in the briefs	Each quarter, review a sample of 30 briefs across European logistics, cross-cultural enterprises and SME clients, looking for systematic differences in tone, advice or quality	AI Owner with Sales Enablement	Quarterly audit report to the governance review
Unfair treatment of reps	The assistant is never used to rank or evaluate reps. Usage data stays aggregated, with no individual leaderboards. Reps are told what is captured. Employee representatives are consulted before launch where the law requires it	HR and Legal	Written policy; HR confirmation before the pilot
Client privacy	Data protection impact assessment before Phase 1. Legal basis confirmed for call recordings. Only the data the briefs need. Seven-year retention. No client data used to train outside models	Legal and compliance	Signed memo; assessment on file

AI and security risks and the policies that answer them

Risk	Policy we will adopt	Owner	Evidence we keep
Wrong or invented advice	Every brief links to the CRM record or call it comes from. Reps rate or correct each brief. An invented fact is logged as an incident. If more than 1 in 20 rated briefs contains one, the feature pauses until it is fixed	AI Owner	Incident log; monthly error rate
Security: text that tries to steer the model	Read-only access with minimum permissions. The assistant retrieves only what the asking rep may already see, and it cannot send email or edit the CRM. Ingested text is treated as data, not instructions. Everything is logged. Planted-instruction tests run before the pilot and before scale	IT Security	Test report; access review; logs
Accountability and the EU AI Act	Initial view: a low-risk advisory tool with clear AI labels. Legal confirms the classification in Phase 0. Using it to evaluate staff could change that, which is why the policy on the previous slide forbids it	Legal and executive sponsor	Classification memo in Phase 0

PART 3: ETHICAL AI FRAMEWORK

Six principles that make this trustworthy

Principle	What we commit to
Transparency	All AI outputs are labelled 'AI suggestion'. No hidden performance tracking. Reps know what is captured
Human control	AI advises, humans decide. Reps can override anything without penalty. The system never contacts clients
Data privacy	GDPR consent frameworks. No external sharing. Seven-year retention matching legal requirements
Fairness	Training includes diverse segments (European logistics, cross-cultural enterprises, SMEs). Quarterly bias audits
Accountability	The AI Owner is responsible for system performance. Quarterly governance reviews. Incident response protocol
EU AI Act	Initial view: low-risk advisory tool with transparency labels. Legal confirms in Phase 0

These are the conditions under which reps will actually trust and use the system.

PART 3: AGENTIC AI WITH HUMAN GUIDANCE

It takes initiative. Humans stay in control.

What it does	How it works	Human control point
Proactive deal alerts	Flags accounts showing risk signals from conversation and CRM patterns	Rep reviews and decides. The AI never contacts a client
Pre-call brief generation	Pulls together history, relationship context and cultural notes	Rep reviews, edits and owns the conversation
Post-call debrief prompts	Generates structured questions based on what was discussed	Rep fills in the answers. The system learns from them
Onboarding knowledge surfacing	Shows relevant examples when new joiners log interactions	Manager and new joiner validate relevance

Human guidance isn't a temporary safeguard. It's a permanent design principle.

The system gets smarter from the quality of the human feedback it receives.

CONCLUSION

In 90 days, we'll have real evidence

Not a vendor pitch. Not a consultant's model.
Data from our own reps, our own clients, our own deals.

The financial case holds	It stays positive in all three scenarios and under every stress test.
The strategic case is urgent	New market expansion, HQ visibility and talent scalability all need this now.
The human case is real	Senior reps are burning out, and new joiners struggle because institutional knowledge is invisible.

Every month we delay: intelligence generated today is not captured and never recovered

THE ASK

First step: review the proposal, spend nothing

1. Today: approve a review and initial assessment

No spend. A short review of this proposal by Legal, IT security, Sales Ops and HR, led by the project owner. Proposed length: 2 weeks. Output: a go or no-go on starting Phase 0.

2. Then: Phase 0 readiness check, €15,000

Only after the review. Maximum loss if we are not ready: €15,000.

3. Then: conditional Phase 1 approval, €94,000

Only if the Phase 0 gates are met: CRM at 75% or more, GDPR memo signed, security design signed off.

Every month this waits: intelligence generated today is not captured and never recovered

Backup

The evidence behind each answer.

Open items are marked. Nothing here is presented as done unless it is.

Done · **Drafted or reported, to confirm** · **Open**

BACKUP: OUR BASELINE

Where our numbers come from

Measure	Value in the model	How we will measure it	Status
CRM completeness	Not yet measured. Phase 0 needs 75%	CRM export of active deals	Open: measure first
Prep time per call	105 minutes (midpoint of 90-120)	Time 5 reps on 3 calls each	Open: assumption
Prepared calls per rep per week	7	Count from CRM and call data	Open: assumption
Follow-up completion	37%	Sales reports	Reported, to verify
Deal cycle	42 days	CRM, last 12 months	Reported, to verify
New-joiner ramp time	6-9 months	CRM and HR, last 4 hires	Reported, to verify

The first Phase 0 deliverable is this table with measured values. The case is recalculated if any of them moves.

BACKUP: DATA HANDLING

Data handling: what is planned and what is open

Question	Plan	Status
What can it read?	CRM records, call transcripts, email threads, proposals, LinkedIn activity, support logs	Drafted
Who can see what?	Read-only. A rep sees only what they may already see	Drafted
Is client data used to train outside models?	No. To be written into the provider contract	Drafted
Is everything logged?	Yes: every retrieval and every output	Drafted
Where is data processed and kept?	Provider terms and processing location are not yet known	Open: Legal and IT
Who signs off?	IT security and Legal, before the pilot starts	Open: Phase 0

BACKUP: PEOPLE AND TIME

Who runs it and what each team gives

Who	What we ask	Time	Status
Executive sponsor	Own the result, approve the gates	To be named	Open: no sponsor yet
Project owner (Director, Sales Enablement)	Lead the review and the pilot	To be agreed	Open
AI Owner	Run the assistant day to day	0.3 FTE in the pilot, 0.5 FTE after	Open: role not filled
Legal, IT security, Sales Ops, HR	Two-week review, then Phase 0 sign-offs	Hours to be agreed with each team	Open
Pilot reps (5-7)	Co-design and test	Weekly 30-minute sessions	Drafted

BACKUP: A SMALLER FIRST STEP

If a smaller first commitment is needed

PROPOSED FALLBACK

Who: 3 reps

How long: 4 weeks

What: one workflow, pre-call briefs, using CRM data only

Measure: time to prepare a call, against the baseline

Output: a measured baseline and the first real result

Cost: to be sized

WHEN TO USE IT

If the review wants a smaller first commitment.

If the CRM is too incomplete for the full pilot.

Status: proposal, not yet costed.

Group approval and overlap: still to check

Does group IT or headquarters have to approve a tool that touches group systems?

Is a similar group project already running?

Who is the contact in group strategy and IT?

Status: open. Check before the review starts. If a similar project exists, propose joining it instead of building a second one.

APPENDIX

Use of AI in developing this business case

This business case was developed with generative AI as a critical thinking partner: to stress-test financial assumptions, identify blind spots in the argument, benchmark against industry frameworks and generate risk questions.

All AI outputs were evaluated against company’s commercial context. The projections use operational data together with the assumptions listed in the written case. The figures were re-checked with a financial model in code in October 2026, which corrected several inconsistencies.

The cultural and relational framing came from stakeholder knowledge and direct analysis. Strategic judgements and all recommendations remain the author's own.